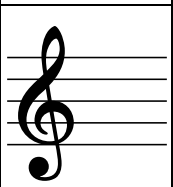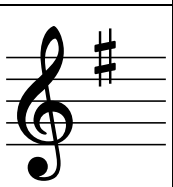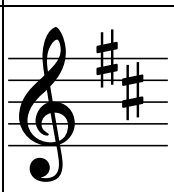
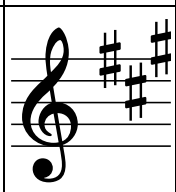
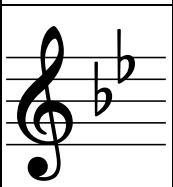
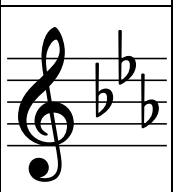
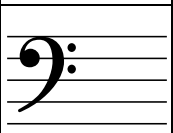
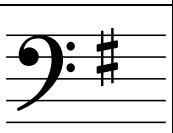
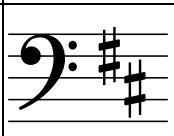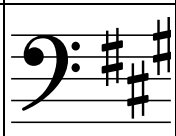
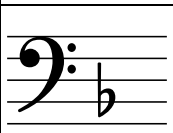
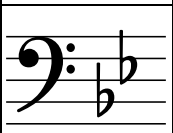
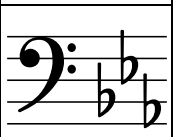
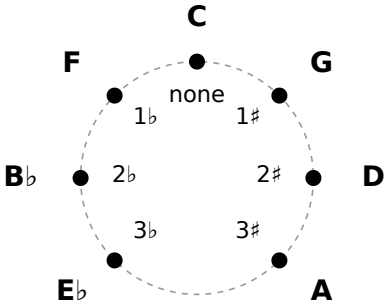
Reading Key Signatures

To name a major key from its key signature:

- **Sharps:** the key is a half step above the last sharp. With F♯ and C♯, the last sharp is C♯; a half step above it is D, so the key is D major.
- **Flats:** the key is the second-to-last flat. With B♭, E♭, and A♭, the second-to-last flat is E♭, so the key is E♭ major. F major has one flat, B♭; memorize it.
- **No sharps or flats:** the key is C major.

Major key	**C**	**G**	**D**	**A**	**F**	**B♭**	**E♭**
Treble							
Bass							
Relative minor	A minor	E minor	B minor	F♯ minor	D minor	G minor	C minor

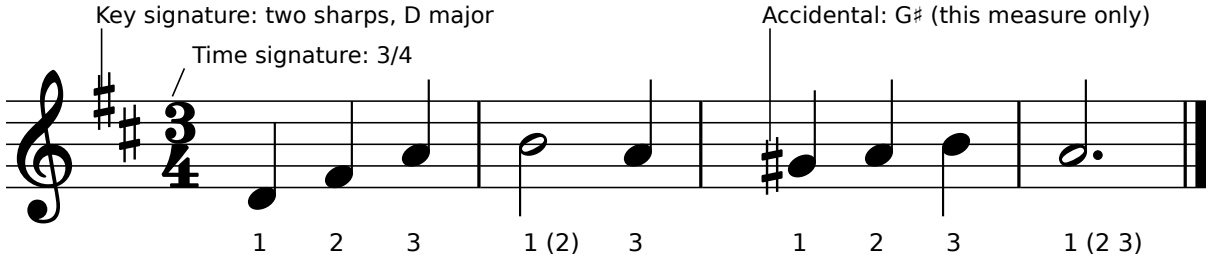
Each major key shares its key signature with a minor key, its **relative minor**, shown in the last row.



The circle of fifths

The **circle of fifths** arranges keys by their key signatures. Moving clockwise from C, each key is five letter names higher (a distance called a fifth, explained in Chapter 15) and has one more sharp. Moving counterclockwise, each key has one more flat. The number of sharps or flats is shown inside the circle.

Putting it together



Every F and C in this melody is sharp because of the key signature. The G♯ in measure 3 is an accidental; it applies only to that measure. A natural sign works the same way: in this key, F♮ cancels the F♯ of the key signature until the next bar line.
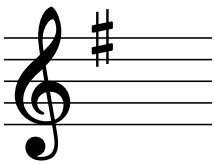
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Name _____ Date _____

Key Signatures
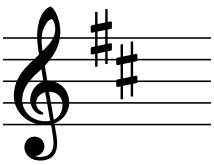
A. Name the major key Write the name of the major key for each key signature.

EXAMPLE



G major
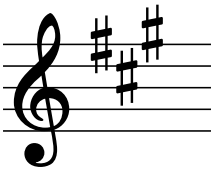
1.



2.



3.
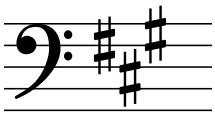


4.



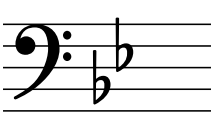
5.
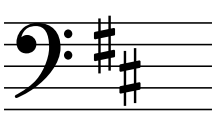


6.



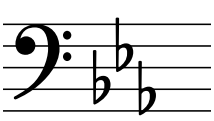
7.



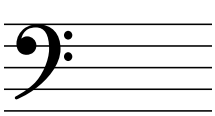
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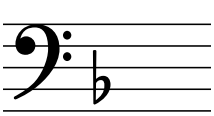


9.



10.
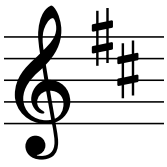


11.



B. Write the key signature Write the key signature for each major key.

EXAMPLE



D major

1.



F major

2.
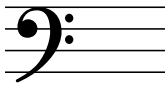


A major

3.
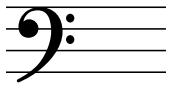


E♭ major

4.
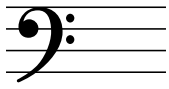


G major

5.
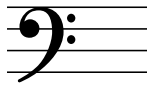


B♭ major

6.



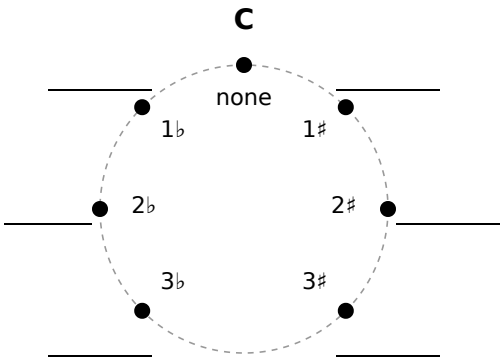
D major

7.



E♭ major

C. The circle of fifths Write the name of each major key on the circle.



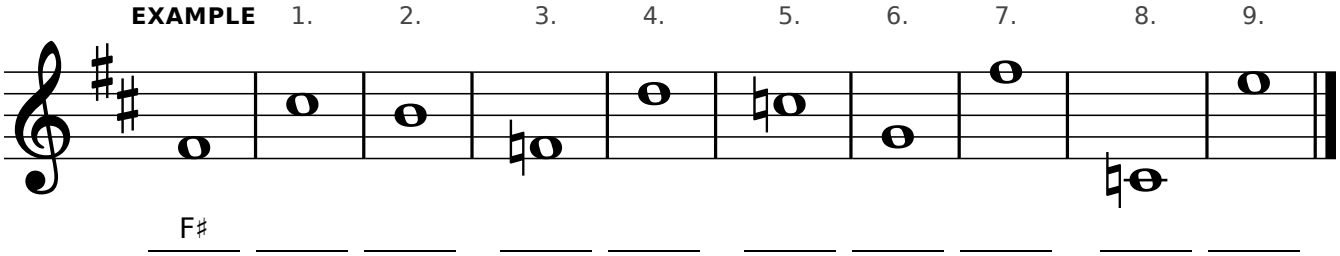
C major is filled in as the example. Moving clockwise, each key has one more sharp; moving counterclockwise from C, each key has one more flat.

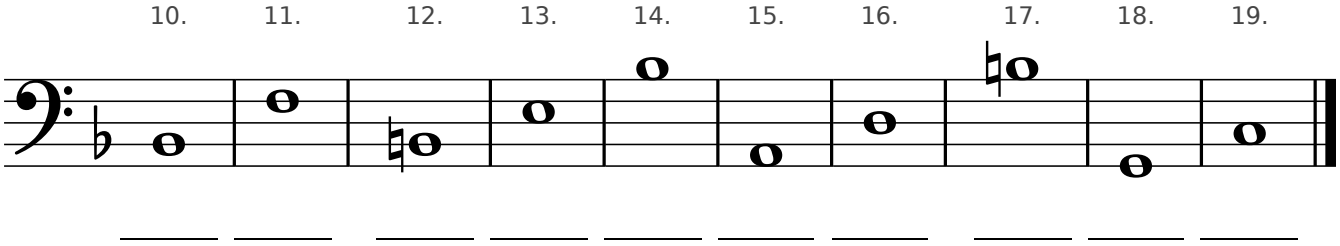
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Name _____ Date _____

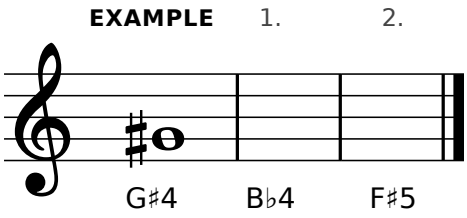
Notes in a Key and Review

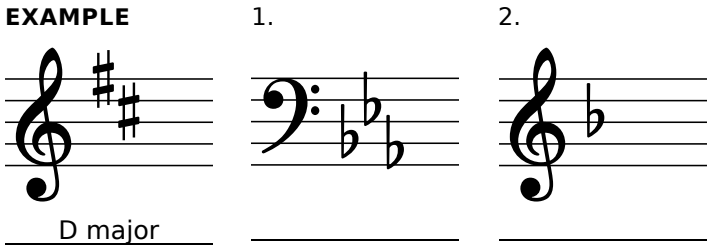
A. Notes in a key Name each note. The key signature applies unless an accidental changes the note.





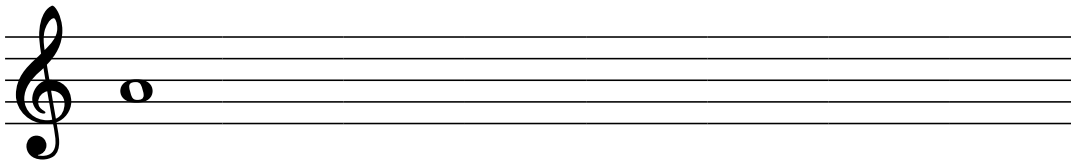
B. Accidentals and key signatures Write the notes with accidentals; then name the major key of each key signature.





C. Write a scale Write the A major scale as whole notes, with the accidentals it needs. Mark each half step with a bracket.

A major



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